How the Americas Hear the Church: *Doctrina Social Católica* y Evangelización en los Medios Electrónicos

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Abstract

Public discourse on religion across the Americas runs through news, television, streaming, radio, and online video (Boyd and Crawford, 2012). Latin American audiences spend nearly double the global average on online news, so analysis needs a hemispheric, not U.S., snapshot (Americas Market Intelligence, 2025). Current approaches often rely on U.S. English sources or official Church documents, overlooking the regional vocabulary and networks through which Catholicism is communicated in media. That gap matters for formation: inquirers in OCIA and parish short courses often first meet the Church in news and digital media before class, yet educators lack shareable text on what themes circulate beforehand.

We present *Catholic Media of the Americas* (2015 to Q2 2026) as **educational infrastructure** for how the Church is proclaimed. Parallel English, Spanish, and Portuguese lexicons collect news, television, radio, and video across the Americas (American Archive of Public Broadcasting, n.d.; Google, n.d.; Internet Archive, 2012; Leetaru, 2015, 2017; Leetaru and Schrodt, 2013), joining core terms (*catholic*, *católico*, *evangelização*), papal names from Leo XIII, and Catholic social teaching titles from *Rerum Novarum* through *Magnifica Humanitas*. We ask: **How do Catholic themes and social teachings circulate as informal learning across countries and languages, and what regional patterns emerge in that media environment?** The pipeline is **Responsible** and **Safe**: NER and regex redaction strip personally identifiable information before release (Bruns et al., 2015; Honnibal et al., 2020). It is **Inclusive** and **Empowering**: the first large-scale de-identified corpus on Catholic media across the Americas (Jockers and Thalken, 2014; Li and Yan, 2025), spanning languages and countries on one shared denominator. Lexicon themes, network analysis, and Jev dual-label excerpts(Li et al., 2026) classify the content, type of discourse, and accuracy of the data.

We find that Catholic media discourse reflects distinct regional traditions rather than a single hemispheric register. Scale: 522,309 geolocated unique-event news rows share one denominator, including 67,724 outside the United States (4,994 in Chile). Fetch coverage skews north: UN developing countries are 9.7% of geolocated news, yet once read, Catholic themes run denser in Latin America than U.S. baselines suggest. Fisher's exact tests (Holm-adjusted) compare theme hits against U.S. news. A quadratic-assignment permutation of the country×teaching graph ($r = 0.38$, $p < 0.001$) matches a pre-specified map; first written mention follows that map in 6/6 topics ($p = 0.006$). Brazil shows greater attention to *Aparecida* and CELAM, Central America to *Óscar Romero*, and Mexico to *Guadalupe* and migration. Spanish-language media favors *evangelio* and *misión* over English vocabulary and canonical titles that dominate U.S. sources.

Transmission and timing differ too. *Aparecida* reaches Chile 16 days after the United States, so U.S. English wire themes can arrive before local registers take shape. Radio *La Retaguardia* (2021): "Opción por los Pobres... frente al hambre y la desigualdad social."

For educators, the corpus shows **which Catholic themes circulate in media before formal instruction and how those themes differ across cultural contexts**. Learners

see Church headlines first as 32% institutional news vs. 3% doctrine. Additionally, only 3% of the data is classified as misunderstanding church teaching. *Catholic Media of the Americas* makes regional and linguistic patterns visible on one shared denominator, offering a foundation for OCIA, parish courses, and materials that reflect discourse people already encounter.

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